



Dr. Mahendra Sharma
Group Pro Chancellor of Ganpat University

A Catalyst for Change: Blueprint to Reimagine Higher Education envisioned by Dr. Mahendra Sharma

Shaping the Future of Education

In India's rapidly evolving knowledge economy, institutional excellence belongs to leaders who anticipate the future and build universities that nurture innovation, future-ready talent, and national progress. At the helm of this transformation is Dr. Mahendra Sharma, Group Pro Chancellor of Ganpat University. With over two decades of experience in industry-focused and skill-based academic design, Dr. Sharma's visionary frameworks have redefined student success, institutional growth and global relevance at Ganpat University. Driven by the ethos "Student First, Character Must" and anchored in values of Hard Work, Integrity, Knowledge, Sincerity, Leadership and Teamwork, the University advances its mission of social upliftment through education under the benevolent blessings of Dr. Ganpat I. Patel (Padma Shri), President and Patron-in-Chief.

Driving Institutional Transformation

Under Dr. Sharma's stewardship, Ganpat University has evolved into one of Gujarat's most progressive higher-education institutions. His tenure has been marked by academic restructuring, technology-driven reforms, and sustained institutional growth. His leadership philosophy is built on bridging theory with practice, knowledge with application, and education with employability, guiding the University's transition into an innovation-driven and industry-integrated academic ecosystem.

Strategic Industry Collaborations

Dr. Sharma has built strategic partnerships with industry leaders including TCS, Tata Motors, IBM, SAS, Maruti Suzuki, Bosch-Rexroth, Stratasys, EC-Council, NASSCOM, EInfochips, etc. to embed industry practice into academics.

Centres of Excellence and National Skill Infrastructure

A defining achievement of Dr. Mahendra Sharma's leadership is the establishment of national-level Centres of Excellence including the National Additive Manufacturing Centre-West, Training and Assessment Centres in Electronics, Rubber, Petrochemicals, Aerospace and Aviation, the Japan-India Institute of Manufacturing, GUNI-Bosch Rexroth Centre for Automation Technology, the Centre for Next-Generation Networks (5G & beyond), etc. These centres function as industry-linked innovation and training hubs, preparing India's workforce for emerging global sectors.

Global Academic Footprint

Dr. Sharma's global outlook has resulted in academic collaborations with Cal Poly Pomona, Michigan State University, Glendel University, Fairleigh Dickinson University and Lincoln University in the United States; Torrens University and Edith Cowan University in Australia; University of Dubai and Abu Dhabi University in the Middle East and Asian Institute of Technology in Thailand, etc. These partnerships enable cross-border research, faculty exchange, and student mobility. His international initiatives including the Global HR, Maritime Conclaves and International Case Writing Workshops in UAE, Skill India Conclave in Goa strategically connect the University

with global academic institutions and industry leaders, strengthening its international collaboration and knowledge-exchange ecosystem.

Recognitions and National Influence

Under Dr. Sharma's visionary leadership, Ganpat University has earned prestigious distinctions, including Centre of Excellence status from the Government of Gujarat, Diamond Rating in QS I-GAUGE Indian University Rankings 2025, NAAC 'A' Grade in its first accreditation cycle, 5-Star GSIRF Rating, and a 4-Star rating in the Ministry of Education's Institutions Innovation Council. Its Pharmacy Institute also ranked among India's Top 125 in NIRF 2024. Dr. Sharma himself has been honored with the Dewang Mehta National Education Leadership Award, Outstanding Tech Visionary Vice-Chancellor Award by The Economic Times, Edupreneur of the Year Award by ASSOCHAM, Stellar Innovator of the Year Award, Innovative CEO of the Year Award by SEPC. He serves on the Empowered Committee of the proposed Higher Education Commission of India (HECI) and holds key leadership roles in ASSOCHAM, CII and AHRD, shaping national higher-education policy and reform.

A Blueprint for the Future

As India advances toward a technology-driven economy, Dr. Mahendra Sharma's leadership exemplifies how visionary governance, industry integration, and global collaboration can redefine universities as engines of national transformation. Ganpat University's evolution under his guidance stands as a blueprint for the future of Indian higher education, where academic excellence, employability, innovation, and societal impact converge.

